Google Maps: Case study & Strategy

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Problem statement:

Enterprise clients are leaving Google Maps because of recurring problems with data integrity, high pricing for large-scale deployments & insufficient API customization options (especially in South Asian countries like India, where competitors like Ola are developing their own local, cheaper map technologies).

Why are we losing users:

Google maps is losing enterprise level users due to issues surrounding data reliability, competitive pricing, limited customization & a gap in technical support.

Market research:

The global digital map market is surging, projected at $28.97B by 2025, powered by enterprise adoption of flexible, API-first, cloud-native GIS platforms.

Industry Size & Growth

Here are the enterprise level market analysis for digital map users

- Global Mobility Market = between **$55B** and **$83B** by 2030(Expected **CAGR 13.3% and 15.8%**.)
- India Digital/Mobile Mapping(MaaS): **$3.5B (2024) growing to $9.5B (2035)**

- Expected CAGR = **15%** driven by following factors

1. Ride-hailing (Ola, Uber)
2. Logistics (Delhivery, Shadowfax)
3. Quick-commerce (Blinkit, Zepto)
4. Food delivery (Swiggy, Zomato)
5. EV fleets

Features and Services market insight:

- **Cloud-based mapping**: 65%+ share, facilitating real-time global collaboration.
- APIs for custom maps, routing, real-time analytics, indoor navigation, and asset tracking.
- **Services Revenue:** Growing at 13.5% CAGR, driven by migration services, integration, managed support, and user enablement.

(Here all the data is calculated for the Mobility-as-a-Service (MaaS) data.)**

Google Maps Market (MaaS) analysis Global vs India:

Metric	Global	India
TAM	$20.63B (2025)	$1.8B+ (estimate, all maps/location)
SAM	$13.8B	$1.0B (Google-addressable)
SOM(Google)	$9.24B (67% share)	$0.67B (67% share/market penetration)
Active Users (2025)	2.2B	480M
API Clients	15M+ (global)	Widespread in logistics, ONDC, retail

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Competitor Analysis:

Vertical	Global Leader(s)	India Leader(s)	Key Requirement/Solution	Strategic Threat / Trend
Automotive OEM	HERE Technologies, TomTom, Google, Esri	MapmyIndia (80% OEM share), Google, Ola Maps	HD maps, real-time, lane-level navigation, offline, V2X	OEMs building in-house (Tesla), Apple Maps, Ola EV pivot, OpenStreetMap
Logistics/Delivery	Google, HERE, Project44, TomTom, EasyPost	Google (post price cut, ONDC deals), Ola Maps (free tier), MapmyIndia	Real-time tracking, routing, ETA, API integration, compliance	API commoditization, regional niche disruptors, pricing wars
E-Commerce/Retail	Google, Esri, Mapbox, TomTom, CARTO	Google, MapmyIndia (Mappls app), Ola Maps (startups/free)	Real-time POI, geofencing, dynamic pricing, scalable APIs	Open-source (OpenStreetMap), regional startups, privacy rules
Government/Smart Cities	Esri, Hexagon, Trimble, HERE, Google	Genesys, MapmyIndia (government contracts), Esri	Digital twins, compliance, data sovereignty, spatial analysis	Open-data mandates, sovereign cloud, local gov AI investments
Telecom	Esri, Hexagon, Trimble, Bentley, HERE	MapmyIndia, LocationGuru (LBS compliance), Esri	Network asset mapping, field force, regulatory compliance	Telcos' self-development, open API standards

AgriTech/Finance	Esri, Planet Labs, Tomorrow.io, Google, FarmLogs	SatSure (satellite/AI), Google, MapmyIndia	Satellite imagery, risk analytics, precision ag, insurance	Cheaper satellite APIs, open data, fintech-Agri integration

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Solutions:

Proactive features such as drone mapping,traffic alerts,vernacular naming etc. Impactful solution to maintain google maps user retention are:-

1. Restore Data Reliability and Trust:

- Implement continuous data validation using AI and manual review, especially for business-critical locations and POIs.

- Offer “Verified Data” guarantees and incident response credits—if data loss or errors affect business, automatic account credits or compensation are provided.

2. Modernize and Simplify Pricing

- Roll out tiered subscription models for enterprise (predictable, discounted rates), alongside continued pay-as-you-go for startups or SMBs.
- Integrate budget controls, overage notifications, and self-service downgrade/upgrade for flexibility in scaling.
- Launch volume-based discounts and periodic “loyalty pricing” for long-term enterprise contracts

3. **A dedicated Mobility SDK(software development kit) designed only for:**

- Ride-hailing (Ola, Uber, Rapido)
- Delivery (Zomato, Swiggy)
- Logistics (Delhivery, Shadowfax)
- EV fleets

4. Accelerate Feature Customization

- Prioritize custom APIs and modular SDKs for enterprises, enabling bespoke branding, routing, analytics, and asset tracking.
- Launch rapid prototyping and co-development programs for key industries (logistics, retail, finance), with direct Google Maps engineer collaboration.

5. **Augmented Reality Local Discovery** - Advanced AR features such as like “Live View" let users explore surroundings in real time, adding an interactive, memorable dimension

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Success Metrics:

NORTH STAR METRIC (GLOBAL + INDIA)

- ❖ “Mobility Partner Retention & Growth” Target (6 Months)
- ❖ 95% global retention100% retention of Indian partners (except Ola)
- ❖ 10–15% increase in mobility API usage worldwide

L1 Metrics Product Performance & Accuracy

- Global Routing Accuracy ↑ **10–12%**
- ETA Accuracy ↑ **15%**
- India-First Routing Accuracy ↑ **20%**
- Driver Route Acceptance ↑ **20%**
- Integration cycle time ↓ **20%**, Mobility API Cost per Trip ↓ **30–40%**
- India Pricing Bundle uptake: **80%**

L2 METRICS

- Routing/ETA accuracy
- Low-latency APIs
- Driver & rider satisfaction

- Toll API adoption
- Partner dashboard usage
- Market sentiment
- Offline navigation adoption

Roadmap (Specially Indian Market)

Phase 1 (Months 0–2): Audit & Bundle Design
Objectives:

- Understand why enterprises leave.
- Design pricing bundles that are competitive, simple, and India-compliant.

Key Actions:

- Audit top 50 Indian enterprise accounts: SKU usage, invoices, complaints.
- Benchmark competitors: MapmyIndia, HERE, Mapbox, Esri.
- Identify high-risk churn accounts.
- Draft India Enterprise Bundles:
    - Essentials, Premium, Vertical Packs
    - Commit + overage rules, SLA levels
- Align legal & finance: INR billing, GST invoices, GeM-ready terms.

Phase 2 (Months 3–4): Pilot & Platform Preparation
Objectives:

- Test new bundles on real accounts.
- Ensure platform supports simplified billing, alerts, and reporting.

Key Actions:

- Update Console:
    - Simplified billing UI

    - Usage alerts (70%/90%/100%)
    - Vertical-specific reporting dashboards
- Select 5–10 pilot accounts per vertical.
- Launch pilot bundles: monitor usage, SLA adherence, satisfaction.
- Adjust bundles/alerts based on feedback.

Phase 3 (Months 5–6): Full Rollout & Anti-Churn Execution

Objectives:

- Roll out India Enterprise Bundles to all target accounts.
- Stop enterprise churn and establish predictable revenue.

Key Actions:

- Full rollout of bundles: Essentials, Premium, Vertical Packs.
- Apply commit + overage model and multi-year discounts.
- Activate anti-churn triggers for declining accounts (>20% usage drop).
- Launch partner/reseller incentives to help with large account adoption.
- Continuous monitoring & weekly reporting.

GTM strategy:

1. Target Verticals

- Logistics / Delivery: 3PLs, e-commerce fleets
- Telecom / Utilities: Tower operators, energy & broadband
- Government / Smart Cities: Ministries, urban planning authorities
- Automotive / OEMs: EV and connected vehicle manufacturers
- AgriTech / BFSI: Satellite-data fintech & insurance

2. Value Proposition

- Predictable pricing: bundles, commit + overage, multi-year discounts
- Global coverage + India-specific local accuracy
- SLA & support: 95%+ uptime, local team, GeM-ready contracts
- Vertical-specific bundles: per vehicle / per asset / per district
- Migration assistance: free onboarding from competitor APIs

3. Global GTM Channels

- Direct Sales: High-value enterprise accounts across key verticals.
- Partners & Integrators: Accenture, Deloitte, Capgemini, IBM, and regional SIs.
- Developer Programs: Startups & SMBs via Google Cloud Marketplace and global events.
- Government / Public Sector: Multi-country compliant bundles with SLA support.
- Digital Marketing & Events: Webinars, case studies, whitepapers, and regional virtual events.

4. Global Pricing & Commercial Strategy

- Essentials: Fixed monthly fee with generous usage caps.
- Premium / Vertical Packs: Commit + overage model with clear usage caps.
- Multi-Year Contracts: 10–30% stepped discounts.
- Localized Billing: Regional currency invoicing, tax/VAT compliance.

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5. MARKETING & BRAND STRATEGY

Developer Marketing

- Developer events across:
  - ❖ India
  - ❖ Europe
  - ❖ US
- SDK documentation improvements
- Code samples on GitHub

Social Media & Content

- Transparent routing videos
- Pothole detection demo
- **“Inside Google Maps India” behind-the-scenes content**

Storytelling:

- Safety
- Cost-efficiency
- India-first optimization
- Global scalability

Product Launch

PHASE 1 : PRE-LAUNCH (Month 0–1)

Objective: Prepare internally and align stakeholders

Internal Enablement

- Internal launch announcement to Google Ads + Cloud + Maps teams
- GTM readiness with Sales, Partnerships, Marketing
- Tech documentation finalization

Early Partner Enablement

- Private demos to Uber, Lyft, Grab, Rapido, Zomato, Swiggy
- Beta access to Mobility SDK
- Signed NDAs + pre-launch agreements

Messaging Framework Freeze

- Positioning: “Global accuracy. India intelligence.”

PHASE 2 : PUBLIC LAUNCH (Month 1–2)

Objective: Announce the new platform globally & in India

Global Launch

- Google Blog: “Introducing Mobility Maps Platform”
- Press coverage in:
- TechCrunch
- The Verge
- Wired
- CNBC
- YouTube launch video showcasing global routing + SDK demo

India Launch

- Economic Times + Mint + YourStory exclusive articles
- Live demo showing pothole detection + India-first routing
- Social posts highlighting “Made for Indian roads”

PHASE 3 : PARTNER ADOPTION (Month 2–4)

Objective: Drive real integrations to lock in partners

1. Global Integration Track

- Uber integrates in at least two priority markets
- Grab and Lyft begin onboarding
- Bolt in EU starts testing Mobility SDK

2. India Integration Track

- Rapido onboarding
- Zomato/Swiggy pilot
- BluSmart EV fleet integration